

63.5 USING "THE" TO SPECIFY

"The" can be followed by a prepositional phrase or a defining relative clause to specify which thing someone is talking about.

The pictures **on the wall** are beautiful.



This makes it clear which pictures are being referred to.

The dog **that I saw earlier** was adorable.



This makes it clear which dog is being talked about.

FURTHER EXAMPLES

The computers **in this office** are all too slow.



The books **that I bought** yesterday are for my son's birthday.



The students **in my classes** are very intelligent and dedicated.



The pastries **that they sell here** are absolutely delicious.



63.6 "THE" WITH ADJECTIVES FOR CERTAIN GROUPS

Some adjectives can be used with the definite article to refer to a group or class of people.

Rich people have bought most of the new houses in this town.



Almost all the houses here are owned by **the rich**.

FURTHER EXAMPLES

Emergency treatment for **the injured** is essential.



Many charities try to protect **the poor**.



The media sometimes portrays **the young** as lazy.



The elderly often need the support of their families.



TIP

These phrases are plural in meaning, but it's incorrect to say "the youngs," etc.